

The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra

Āryakṣitigarbhāṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita · Toh 641 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སའ་སྒྲི་པའི་མཚན་བརྒྱ་མརྒྱ་པ་གཟུངས་སྒྲས་དང་བཅས་པ།

Toh 641 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Āryakṣitigarbhāṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita and in Tibetan as the Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra. It is a liturgical and devotional work centered on the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha, the "Earth Womb," and presents his one hundred and eight names alongside accompanying dhāraṇī and mantra formulas held to bestow spiritual qualities on those who recite them. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, the collection of canonical scriptures attributed to the Buddha, and situates itself within a visionary scene in which the Blessed One presides over a sacred vajra maṇḍala and commissions Kṣitigarbha's dhāraṇī before an assembled congregation. As one of several canonical texts dedicated to Kṣitigarbha, it reflects the widespread veneration of this bodhisattva as a protector and benefactor who extends his compassionate activity across the earth.

In the language of India:
Āryakṣitigarbhāṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita. In the language of Tibet: The Noble One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha, Together with Dhāraṇī and Mantra.

I pay homage to the great king of maṇḍalas, the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha.

Oṃ sumbha ni sumbha, hara cara, mahāpāśamarute, amogha vajrasattva svāhā.

Then, as soon as this dhāraṇī, the bestower of qualities, was proclaimed, the sacred vajra maṇḍala, along with the glaciers of Mount Tise, was set in motion and trembled.

To Kṣitigarbha, at the empowerment of the assembly, the Blessed One who holds the vajra spoke:

"O greatly fortunate one, excellent, excellent!

You have spread yourself wide over the surface of the earth.

Your dhāraṇī is renowned,

and it gives rise to a gathering of immeasurable qualities.

Hearing it repels

the suffering and faults of all sentient beings.

While wandering through saṃsāra,

one is not stained by any fault,

just as a lotus in the mud

is not stained by the mud's defilement.

Whatever embodied being it may be

who holds and carries your secret mantra —

not even one among them

shall ever turn away from awakening.

Whatever wise one hears this supreme dhāraṇī mantra

and develops devotion to it

shall certainly attain every quality

without any doubt."

Then the entire assembled retinue rose, and the lord of the earth recited the one hundred and eight names of Kṣitigarbha, the supreme of earths:

Kṣitigarbha, the great chief,

he whose gaze is like a flash of lightning,

the crowned one who pervades the earth,

endowed with abundant excellence and supreme prosperity,

the wise one, maker of wisdom, object of veneration,

the foremost, the ascetic, the teacher,

whose way is that of wind, grounded and possessed of foundation,

whose mind is svāhā, the foremost in compassion,

the supreme sun of omniscience,

renowned as the knower of the essence and the essence itself,

who sports with secret mantra and sports widely,

the lord of the earth, possessed of the art of dance,

graceful and fair of face, endowed with the art of the dancer,

the teacher who directly shows the fruit,

the knower of the essence of Subhūti's intelligence,

who has found the essence and is without fear,

the protector who holds the form of a buddha,

who perceives everything without remainder through wisdom,

who removes faults such as attachment and the rest,

the teacher who displays the great art of dance,
the teacher who is like a wish-granting tree,
the lord of space, sweet of voice,
who is the great sun itself,
surrounded by the blazing of the great lord,
who enjoys boundless qualities and riches,
the lord of the earth, possessed of a domain,
who greatly enjoys the wealth of Dharma,
the great snow-lake of an ocean of qualities,
who enjoys various qualities,
the supreme of the Tathāgata's lineage,
skilled in the profound methods and means,
fearless in the Great Vehicle,
of great renown, the great offering sound,
the maṇḍala-holder renowned as the moon,
the great Vajradhara of a hundred names,
the vajra maṇḍala with a crown of flowers,
the great intelligence, with long arms,
the great lotus, greatly powerful,
the great secret mantra, the great assembly,
who is the great earth, who is Mount Meru,
Vajrapāṇi whose qualities are certain,
adorned with a crown of jeweled flowers,
who enjoys the vast expanse of equality,
the vast-fielded one who possesses an ocean,
the bearer of vajra light, possessed of the vajra,
the lord of the earth, like Meru,
who enjoys the earth with a fine enjoyment,
with brilliant, waving weapons,
renowned as the vessel of the infinite expanse,
the eloquent one who completely conquers the vajra,
whose eyes are just slightly reddened at their centers,
bound by a crown of blue flowers,
greatly energetic, with long arms,
the stable one who bestows comfort in stability,
the greatly auspicious caravan-leader,
who is like the snowy mountain Meru,

the great lord equal to Yama, king of Death,
the powerful lord Viṣṇu (Kṣitigarbha as) Viṣṇu,
the supreme worldly one of the lineage of Brahmā and the buddhas,
whose domain of conduct is suchness as it truly is.

the jewel-crest, laughing greatly,
joyful, wearing varied garments,
with far-reaching gaze and wide eyes,
unobstructed like space,
the jewel-crown unimpeded and immeasurable,
the cause for the absence of craving in the three realms,
the tamed one who clears away the stain of afflictions,
pure and clean, possessor of the restoration ceremony,
transcending combat through complete subjugation,
green in complexion, a refuge, greatly compassionate,
widely renowned through power,
whose domain of conduct is known through contemplation,
the hero who strikes fear like a lion,
crusher of the hearts of the hostile,
the lord of renown who dwells among his domains,
one from whom vast joy arises,
knower of lineages, knower of the essence of lineages,
to be venerated throughout all lineages,
the basis that produces the supreme royal lineage,
adorned with the vajra maṇḍala,
supremely renowned beneath the vajra ground,
the great and mighty bearer of the knowledge-mantra,
supremely eminent and all-pervading,
with beautiful throat, free from illness,
the purified protector and Teacher,
who clearly reveals the path of the buddhas,
who ripens liberation and causes prostration,
adorned by all the maṇḍalas without exception,
fully entered and skilled in the maṇḍalas,
the vajra master, support of all qualities,
the supremely pure bestower of accomplishments,
the comprehender of what is proper and improper,

master of the root and yellow of the maṇḍala,
endowed with the light of green rays,
robed in yellow, wearing yellow garments,
adorned by all the maṇḍalas without exception,
with reddened corners of the eyes, the glory of the moon,
from whom radiate the lights of manifold jewels,
who blazes with the power of a hundred vajras,
evenness itself, equal and unstained,
with a perfect body and pure garments,
knowing purity and endowed with purity,
possessing pure Dharma, a being of radiance,
the element-endowed one who dispels craving,
the wise one who exhausts saṃsāra,
whose domain is conduct known through proper understanding,
the great essence of the vajra-ocean,
Vajrasattva, the greatly virtuous,
the element-endowed, the infinitely wise,
of entirely good and renowned radiance,
Kṣitigarbha, the great essence,
who guides through the essence of the vajra,
the immeasurable, completely fulfilling what is immeasurable,
dwelling in the domain of the supremely excellent,
chief of what is profound and clear,
with the cool rays of the moon's disk,
one who generates joy and delight,
whose domain is the vast expanse of primordial wisdom,
as fierce as the force of the wind,
wrathful, yet cleansing away what is fierce,
causing victory, and the peace of the Victor,
making the glory of the Victor, bestowing joy,
Mount Sumeru, Tise, and Malaya,
penetrating the profound domain of conduct,
the great essence of the precious vajra,
possessing the domain of the ground of the earth,
the light arising from the precious rock,
adorned by the pure vajra maṇḍala,
greatly delighting in the Tathāgata,

the forceful and powerful support of glory,
brilliantly radiant, glorious, and pure,
the great sovereign, lord of the ten directions.

Thus, having praised the great Vajradhara with these hundred and eight supreme names, Vajrasattva spoke, the supreme master of the three vajra grounds:

Those who know the essence of these qualities and who recite these hundred and eight supreme names, thereby averting misdeeds — I have seen no other means equal to this on the face of the earth.

These sacred hundred and eight names bring joyful accomplishment of everything, clearing away all evil and certainly removing every stain — such are their assured qualities.

Therefore all those who are diligent and who desire excellence and prosperity should always recite these hundred and eight virtuous names.

These sacred hundred and eight names are the supreme unsurpassed abode of all intentions and all wealth, bestowing vast glory and splendor.

With a mind of utter clarity, whoever clearly calls to mind the names of Kṣitigarbha and recites the supreme qualities by which all wishes are perfectly accomplished —

Whoever recites these sacred hundred and eight names
of the one who holds vast glory and excellence
will swiftly be liberated from all suffering.

The hundred and eight names of the noble Kṣitigarbha, together with the dhāraṇī mantra, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The opening Sanskrit title is given in Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit and is rendered back into Sanskrit: Āryakṣitigarbhāṣṭottaraśataka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mantra-sahita, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Together with Mantra of the One Hundred and Eight Names of Kṣitigarbha."

The phrase "Blessed One who holds the vajra" renders རྒྱལ་པོ་ལྷ་མོ་འཛིན་པ་པུ་ཆེན་པོ་, which could refer either to Vajrasattva or to the Buddha in a tantric context as the vajra-holder; the context of the maṇḍala trembling and the empowerment suggests a tantric framing, but the exact identity of the speaker is left somewhat ambiguous in the text itself.

"Mount Tise" is the Tibetan name for Mount Kailāsh, a sacred mountain associated with tantric geography.

The phrase "Subhūti's intelligence" renders རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷན་པོའི་ཤེས་པ་, which is grammatically ambiguous; it may mean "knower of the essence of vast intelligence" (རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷན་པོ་ = "vast expanse") rather than the proper name Subhūti, but Rabajor as Subhūti is a plausible reading given the liturgical context.

The final lines equating Kṣitigarbha with Yama, Viṣṇu, Brahmā, and the buddhas reflect the standard Mahāyāna and tantric literary convention of subsuming all deities within the bodhisattva's identity, not a claim of literal identity.

- The phrase rendered "root and yellow of the maṇḍala" translates a compound that likely refers to specific iconographic colors within the maṇḍala system; the precise technical meaning of "rtsa ser" as a paired designation may refer to the central golden element of the maṇḍala, but the exact referent is uncertain.

The three mountains named — Sumeru, Tise (Mount Kailāsh), and Malaya — appear here as objects of comparison or as domains, functioning as epithets of the praised deity's grandeur.

The closing sentence in the Tibetan is syntactically incomplete, trailing off mid-construction; the translation reflects this open-ended quality faithfully, as the passage clearly continues beyond what is given here.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.